Valerii Kliuchnikov

Senior Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer (Go) with 9 years shipping production backend systems across fintech, AI tooling, and social platforms. Currently at Playneta's Kiss 2.0 social platform (22K DAU, $2.4M ARR run-rate) — in the first 6 months shipped three production services (LLM chat translation at approx. 9.6M messages/mo and 0.3% of product revenue, rule-based UGC moderation, and a monorepo-wide DLQ layer) and contributed across 22 of 28 monorepo services. Previously delivered enterprise RBAC and payment systems at 2M+ daily transactions, 10K+ checks/sec, and zero-downtime migrations for 1M+ users. Hands-on tech lead: 30+ technical interviews conducted and 3 engineers mentored. Based in Barcelona; after 7 years of full-time senior roles, spent 2025-2026 on B2B contract engagements via Spanish autonomo setup during relocation. Now returning to a long-term full-time backend engineering role with EU or North American companies.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, SQL, Python, JavaScript
Backend: Microservices, REST, gRPC, Protobuf, Gin, Echo, chi, GORM, Wire DI, DDD
Data: PostgreSQL, ScyllaDB, Cassandra, Redis
Messaging: Kafka, Redpanda, RabbitMQ, asynq
AI/LLM: MCP, OpenRouter, multi-model routing, Agno, Claude Code
Cloud/DevOps: GCP (GKE, Pub/Sub), Kubernetes, Helm, Docker, Terraform, GitLab CI, Jenkins
Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry
Security: OAuth 2.0, JWT, RBAC
Compliance: GDPR, PCI DSS
Testing: Table-driven tests, testify, integration testing, k6

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Playneta Limited | *Senior Software Engineer (B2B Contract)* May 2026 – Present
Nicosia, Cyprus – Remote

- Contributing engineer on Kiss 2.0 social platform (22K DAU, $2.4M ARR run-rate): 30 Go microservices across Redpanda (360 topics, 52 consumer groups) and multi-region infra on DigitalOcean and Yandex Cloud; authored 310 commits across 22 of 28 monorepo services; main author of translation and moderation services, major contributor to shared library (DLQ, moderation and translation clients).
- Designed and shipped a real-time LLM chat translation service in Go serving approx. 9.6M messages/mo at 612ms median / 981ms p95 end-to-end; auto-detection across 26 source languages, targets selected dynamically from conversation roster; two-stage pipeline (Kafka consumer to asynq worker) hardened against hallucinations, truncation and concurrent updates.
- Cost-optimised two-model LLM routing via OpenRouter (Gemini 2.5 Flash Lite primary, GPT-4.1 Nano fallback) with per-model circuit breaker and Redis cross-message cache at 25% hit rate, keeping total LLM spend at approx. $591/month (approx. $61 per 1M messages, approx. $7K/year, 0.3% of platform revenue); full per-translation provenance (model, tokens, cost, latency) in Cassandra and Kafka events.
- Translation infra reliability: stage-2 LLM worker processes 5.1M tasks/week at 99.995% success; HTTP API serves 34M requests/24 days at 99.998% success, p99 read 183ms; Helm-based Kubernetes with HPA across API, shared-consumer and worker pools.
- Built a platform-wide UGC moderation service from scratch using strict DDD layering (Postgres,

ScyllaDB, Redis, Wire DI); rule-based engine (Aho-Corasick dictionary and regex for contacts and links) covering nicknames, bio, club name/status and chat messages across 5 content types; bulk dictionary API with versioning, per-field rejection codes and a userId-scoped check endpoint.
- Moderation serves approx. 99K checks/day at p99 = 10ms, 10x under the client fail-open deadline, with zero errors in 24 days; integrated into user, chat and clubs so all text UGC and anti-spam routes through a single moderation path.
- Designed a reusable DLQ layer for Redpanda consumers in the shared go-kiss2 library; adopted by 4 services (chat, clubs, translation, migration), capturing approx. 1.8K failed messages/day at a 0.016% failure rate (approx. 1 in 6,100 consumed events) into a single versioned dlq topic for later triage.
- DLQ phase 1 (produce-only, at-most-once with 3 in-process retries) in production; phase 2 (at-least-once semantics with per-group self-replay, configurable ReplayDelay and MaxReplays, dlq.parked for exhausted messages, opt-in Permanent error marker) designed and implemented, pending main merge.

Refact.ai | *Software Engineer (B2B Contract)* September 2025 – April 2026
London, UK – Remote

- Architected and delivered 10+ MCP server integrations and third-party connectors from scratch, expanding the platform's tool ecosystem autonomously in a fully async remote setup.
- Designed a declarative MCP preset system that streamlined user onboarding and reduced configuration overhead for new integrations.
- Built in-chat MCP configuration flow via chatbot interface, enabling users to connect and configure external tools without leaving the conversation context.
- Implemented an OAuth 2.0 and token-based authorization framework for secure authentication across external system integrations.

Confidential Fintech Platform (under NDA) | *Senior Software Engineer* May 2024 – July 2025
Remote

- Designed and delivered a Go-based RBAC platform (PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka) serving 1M+ enterprise users under financial-regulator compliance; zero-downtime migration completed in 4 months, lifting permission-assignment success rate by 50%.
- Built an automated data-sync pipeline in Go for 200K legal entities using event-driven architecture (Kafka and gRPC), cutting manual data updates by 60% and reducing staleness by 75%.
- Architected a high-throughput notification service (Go, Kafka, PostgreSQL) processing 1M+ alerts/day at 99.9% uptime across multiple consumer groups.
- Extended RBAC with real-time transaction-limit enforcement (10K+ checks/sec over 1M active accounts) reducing limit-breach errors by 90%; designed for horizontal scaling on Kubernetes.
- Conducted 30+ technical interviews, defined hiring rubrics, and mentored 3 engineers through structured onboarding, cutting ramp-up time by 40%.

Quadcode | *Software Engineer* May 2022 – May 2024
Larnaca, Cyprus – Hybrid

- Owned Go payment services layer (Redis, PostgreSQL, Kafka) processing up to 1M transactions/day across multiple crypto and fiat providers; optimised concurrency patterns cutting server load by 40% and reducing pipeline maintenance costs by 70%.
- Prototyped an advanced Crypto Payment Provider integration, securing executive approval and rolling it out to three teams.
- Designed a declarative integration framework that reduced new payment-provider onboarding from 2 weeks to 1 week.
- Rebuilt GitLab CI with precommit hooks, accelerating pipelines by 20% and reducing review cycles by 90%.
- Delivered GDPR-compliant anonymization and PCI DSS tokenization services from scratch.

ProCSy | *Software Engineer* March 2020 – May 2022
Moscow, Russia – Remote

- Built 10+ Hyperledger Fabric smart contracts, automating workflows and reducing manual reconcili-

ation by 70%.

- Established an SMTP mailing system handling 10K+ daily emails at 98% delivery rate.
- Decomposed a monolithic application into 6 microservices, cutting deployment time from 30 to 5 minutes.
- Automated CI pipelines with GitLab CI and golangci-lint, achieving 90% reduction in feedback cycles.

ITMO University | *Junior Software Engineer* January 2018 – March 2020
Saint Petersburg, Russia – Hybrid

- Developed a modular resource-visualization system (Go, OOP) and a GORM-based relational schema for an internal simulation platform used in research courseware.

PROJECTS

Personal AI PM. Agentic personal project manager that plans, tracks and drives my work and life tasks across inbox, calendar and todo surfaces; built end-to-end through AI-paired development with Claude Code.

ESP32 ecosystem. Hands-on embedded hobby: DIY portable cyberdeck ("Decker") and a self-hosted smart home, both on ESP32 microcontrollers with custom firmware and local-first automation.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering September 2015 – June 2019
ITMO University, Saint Petersburg, Russia
Faculty of Software Engineering and Computer Systems

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: Russian (Native), English (Professional working proficiency)
Interests: 3D printing, RC aircraft, microelectronics